EVENTS · 10 MIN READ

Events our customers train for: brevets, triathlon, Hyrox and more

Most serious customers are training for something. If you know the event, you know the distance, the rules and the kit they need before they ask. Make "What are you training for?" a standard question in every conversation.

1. Brevets (BRM)

A brevet is a long-distance ride that must be finished inside a time limit. It is not a race: there are no rankings, only finishers. In India brevets are run by local clubs under Audax India Randonneurs, and Pune has an active club. Riders are called randonneurs.

DISTANCE	TIME LIMIT
200 km	13 h 30 min
300 km	20 h
400 km	27 h
600 km	40 h

- The clock never stops. Food stops, punctures and sleep all count inside the limit.
- Riders pass **controls** along the route, each with its own closing time.
- Brevets are **self-supported**. No support car may follow the rider. They carry or buy what they need.
- Front and rear lights and a reflective vest are compulsory for night riding.
- A rider who finishes a 200, 300, 400 and 600 in one season earns the title **Super Randonneur**.
- The famous goal is **Paris-Brest-Paris**: 1,200 km in 90 hours, held in France every four years.

What a brevet rider buys: an endurance road bike such as the Trek Domane, 28 to 32 mm tyres, two sets of lights with a backup, a reflective vest, frame and saddle bags, a GPS computer with long battery life, a power bank, spare tubes and tools, nutrition, and a bike fit. Offer a full service a week before the ride, not the day before.

2. Triathlon and Ironman

A triathlon is swim, then bike, then run, with no break. The changeovers are called transitions: T1 from swim to bike, T2 from bike to run.

DISTANCE	SWIM	BIKE	RUN
Sprint	750 m	20 km	5 km
Olympic	1.5 km	40 km	10 km

Half, or Ironman 70.3	1.9 km	90 km	21.1 km
Full, or Ironman	3.8 km	180 km	42.2 km

- **Ironman** is a brand name for full and half distance races. "70.3" is the total distance of the half in miles. A full Ironman must be finished within 17 hours.
- India hosts an Ironman 70.3 in Goa, and many customers travel abroad for a full.
- Most long races are **non-drafting**: riders must keep a gap, and triathlon bikes are allowed. **Draft-legal** races require a road bike.

What a triathlete buys: for a first sprint or Olympic race, a road bike with clip-on aero bars is enough. For 70.3 and full distance, a triathlon bike with a proper fit. Then a tri suit, a multisport watch from Garmin or Coros that records all three sports in one go, an indoor trainer for weekday training, hydration for the bike, nutrition, and a bike box for travel.

3. Duathlon and aquathlon

- **Duathlon**: run, bike, run. No swim. Popular with cyclists who do not swim.
- **Aquathlon**: swim and run. No bike.

A duathlete needs the same bike setup as a triathlete of that distance.

4. Hyrox

Hyrox is an indoor fitness race. Every event in the world uses the same format, so times can be compared. The athlete runs 1 km, then does one workout station, and repeats this eight times: 8 km of running and 8 stations in total.

STATION	WORKOUT
1	SkiErg, 1,000 m
2	Sled push, 50 m
3	Sled pull, 50 m
4	Burpee broad jumps, 80 m
5	Rowing, 1,000 m
6	Farmers carry, 200 m
7	Sandbag lunges, 100 m
8	Wall balls

People enter alone, as doubles, or as a relay team. There is no cycling in Hyrox, so do not try to sell a bike for it. **What a Hyrox athlete buys from us:** a sports watch with heart rate, a heart rate strap, Shokz open-ear headphones for training, hydration and nutrition. Many also use an indoor trainer or smart bike for low-impact fitness between running days.

5. Other events you will hear about

EVENT	WHAT IT IS
Cyclothon or gran fondo	A mass-participation road ride, often 25 to 100 km. Timed, with helmets compulsory. Many first-time buyers come in because of one.
Ultra race	A non-stop long-distance race, such as the Deccan Cliffhanger from Pune to Goa. Unlike a brevet it is a race, and riders have a support crew and vehicle.
Time trial	Each rider starts alone and races the clock. This is where TT bikes and deep wheels are used.
Criterium	A short, fast race of many laps on a closed circuit.
MTB race	Cross-country races on trails, from a single day to multi-day stage races.
Everesting	Riding one climb again and again in a single ride until the total climbing reaches 8,848 m, the height of Everest.
Marathon and ultra running	42.2 km and longer. These customers buy watches, headphones and nutrition.

6. Brevet or ultra race: do not mix them up

- Brevet: not a race, self-supported, no follow car.
- Ultra race: a race, with a crew and a support vehicle.

The kit is different. A brevet rider carries everything on the bike and needs bags. An ultra racer keeps spares in the car and wants the bike light and fast.

7. Using events to sell well

- Ask what they are training for, and **when**. Put the event and date in the CRM note.
- Work backwards. A bike should be bought and fitted at least 6 to 8 weeks before the event. Nothing new on race day: no new saddle, shoes or position in the last week.
- Book the pre-event service about a week ahead.
- Follow up after the event. Ask how it went. That call often leads to the next purchase and a review.
- Be honest about what the event does not need. A first 200 km brevet does not need a carbon race bike.

Remember these

- Brevets: 200 km in 13.5 h, 300 in 20 h, 400 in 27 h, 600 in 40 h. Self-supported, not a race.
- Triathlon: sprint, Olympic, 70.3 and full. Road bike with clip-ons for short races, tri bike for long ones.
- Hyrox: 8 × 1 km run plus 8 stations. No bike. Sell wearables, audio and nutrition.
- Ask what they are training for and when. Nothing new in the last week before an event.